ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

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Campus Safety and Scam Awareness: Protect Your Money and Yourself

Practical habits against fraud, theft and unsafe situations on and around campus

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Students lose money to fake agents, fake accommodation, fake scholarship portals and social-engineering calls. This pack covers how common scams work, how to verify before paying, safe meet-up habits and what to do after an incident.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Recognise common student-targeted scams and the pressure tactics they use.
- Verify a person, offer or portal before sending money.
- Apply personal-safety habits for late travel and meet-ups.
- Report incidents correctly and preserve evidence.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

How scams work

Fraud relies on urgency, authority and isolation. Break any one and the scam usually fails.

- Fake accommodation agents demand a deposit before inspection.
- Fake scholarship or job portals charge an application or processing fee.
- Impersonation calls claim to be from the bursary, your bank or a lecturer.
- Fake buyers overpay and ask for a refund of the difference.
- Investment schemes promise unrealistic daily returns and pay early members with later members' money.
- Pressure to act immediately and secretly is the strongest warning sign.

> **The pause rule**
> No legitimate transaction collapses because you took ten minutes to verify. If someone insists you cannot check, do not pay.

Verify before you pay

Verification is a process, not a feeling about the person.

1. Confirm identity through an independent channel you found yourself.
2. Verify ownership or authority with the institution, landlord or employer.
3. Never pay into a personal account for an institutional fee.
4. Ask for a written receipt and keep records of the conversation.
5. Check the official website or portal rather than a link sent to you.
6. For goods, inspect before paying; for services, agree milestones.

Personal safety and reporting

Most risk is managed by routine rather than by fear.

- Share your movement with a trusted friend when travelling late.
- Use well-lit, populated routes and registered transport.
- Meet buyers or sellers in public, busy locations during daylight.
- Keep bank alerts on and never share your PIN or OTP with anyone.
- Avoid displaying expensive items unnecessarily.
- After an incident, report to campus security and the police, and preserve messages and receipts.

Risk is mostly about routine

Most campus incidents happen in predictable circumstances: late at night, alone, on routes with poor lighting, or during periods of unusual movement such as examination week and end of semester. Knowing the pattern lets you change it rather than living in fear.

Practical measures are unglamorous: travel in groups at night, tell someone your route and expected arrival time, keep your phone charged, know where security posts are, and avoid unlit shortcuts even when they are shorter.

Your valuables are most at risk during transitions - moving into a hostel, examination periods, crowded functions, and the days before holidays. Most theft on campus is opportunistic and happens when attention is elsewhere.

Scams that target students